

KS3: Medieval England & The Struggle for Power (1066–1485)

"How did power shift in Medieval England?"

MASTERY PACK: COMPLETE UNIT

Operative / Student Name: _____

Target: Total Recall of 160 Crucial Questions

RESTRICTED ACCESS - MASTER YOUR MEMORY

How to Hack Your Memory

(Rules of Engagement)

1. Never Just Read

Reading the answers feels like learning, but it's an illusion. You must force your brain to struggle to find the answer. The struggle is what builds memory pathways.

2. Cover, Recall, Check

Cover the answer sheet. Write your answer down in the notes section (or say it out loud). Only then are you allowed to check 'The Vault'.

3. Track Your Threat Level

Use the R-A-G (Red, Amber, Green) checkboxes next to every question after you attempt it.

- ☐ **Green:** I nailed it instantly.
- ☐ **Amber:** I got it, but I had to think hard.
- ☐ **Red:** My mind went blank. (Revisit these tomorrow).

4. The Interrogation (Homework Protocol)

True mastery requires testing under pressure. Hand 'The Vault' (answers) to your parent or guardian. They will test you on 20 random questions. They hold the score; they hold the signature.

Lesson 1: 1066 - Why did three men claim one throne, and how did William win?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
1	What century are we currently studying?	☐	☐	☐	
2	Who were the native people living in England before 1066?	☐	☐	☐	
3	What was the most important building in a medieval village?	☐	☐	☐	
4	What is an heir to the throne?	☐	☐	☐	
5	Who was the English King that died in January 1066 without a clear heir?	☐	☐	☐	
6	What was the 'Witan' in Anglo-Saxon England?	☐	☐	☐	
7	Which group of people were famous for raiding England in longships?	☐	☐	☐	
8	Where is Normandy located?	☐	☐	☐	
9	What does it mean to claim the throne?	☐	☐	☐	
10	What is a power vacuum?	☐	☐	☐	
11	Which claimant to the throne was an Anglo-Saxon Earl?	☐	☐	☐	
12	Which claimant to the throne was a feared Viking warrior?	☐	☐	☐	
13	What promise did William of Normandy claim Edward the Confessor had made to him?	☐	☐	☐	
14	Why was the English army exhausted before the Battle of Hastings?	☐	☐	☐	
15	What defensive tactic did the English use at the top of Senlac Hill?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
16	How did William the Conqueror manage to break the English defense?	☐	☐	☐	
17	According to legend, how was Harold Godwinson killed at Hastings?	☐	☐	☐	
18	What famous piece of embroidery tells the story of the Norman Conquest?	☐	☐	☐	
19	Which event is often seen as the beginning of the end for Anglo-Saxon England?	☐	☐	☐	
20	What advantage did the Norman army have over the Anglo-Saxons at Hastings?	☐	☐	☐	

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Parent/Guardian Authentication (Signature): _____

Date: _____

Lesson 2: Castles, Terror, and the Domesday Book - How did William control England?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
21	Which powerful English Earl claimed the throne because of a deathbed promise?	☐	☐	☐	
22	Which Viking warrior claimed the throne based on an old treaty?	☐	☐	☐	
23	Who claimed the throne because of a broken oath sworn on holy relics?	☐	☐	☐	
24	Where did King Harold march his army to fight the Vikings?	☐	☐	☐	
25	Who won the Battle of Stamford Bridge?	☐	☐	☐	
26	Why was Harold's army exhausted before fighting William?	☐	☐	☐	
27	Where did William the Conqueror's army land in England?	☐	☐	☐	
28	Who supported William's invasion, making it a religious crusade?	☐	☐	☐	
29	What was the name of the battle between Harold and William?	☐	☐	☐	
30	In what year did all these three battles take place?	☐	☐	☐	
31	What was a 'motte' in an early Norman castle?	☐	☐	☐	
32	What was the 'bailey' in an early Norman castle?	☐	☐	☐	
33	Why did William choose to build motte and bailey castles?	☐	☐	☐	
34	In what year did the 'Harrying of the North' take place?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
35	What was the long-term consequence of the Harrying of the North?	☐	☐	☐	
36	What language did the new Norman aristocracy speak?	☐	☐	☐	
37	What did the Domesday Book record?	☐	☐	☐	
38	Why was the survey known as the 'Domesday' Book by the English people?	☐	☐	☐	
39	Under the feudal system, what did a knight provide to a baron in exchange for land?	☐	☐	☐	
40	What did the feudal system ensure for William the Conqueror?	☐	☐	☐	

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Lesson 3: Crown vs Church: Why did Henry II clash with Thomas Becket?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
41	Who won the Battle of Hastings to become King of England?	☐	☐	☐	
42	What type of castles did the Normans first build to control England rapidly?	☐	☐	☐	
43	What was the 'motte'?	☐	☐	☐	
44	What brutal tactic did William use to destroy northern rebellions?	☐	☐	☐	
45	What was the purpose of the Domesday Book (1086)?	☐	☐	☐	
46	Who was the Viking claimant killed at Stamford Bridge?	☐	☐	☐	
47	What material were the first Norman castles made from?	☐	☐	☐	
48	What was the 'bailey' in a castle?	☐	☐	☐	
49	What does 'feudalism' mean?	☐	☐	☐	
50	How many people died of starvation due to the Harrying of the North?	☐	☐	☐	
51	Why did Henry II dislike the separate Church courts?	☐	☐	☐	
52	What was the relationship between Henry II and Thomas Becket before Becket became Archbishop?	☐	☐	☐	
53	What did Becket start wearing under his luxurious clothes after becoming Archbishop?	☐	☐	☐	
54	What controversial document did Henry II issue to try to limit Church power in 1164?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
55	How long was Thomas Becket in exile in France?	☐	☐	☐	
56	What action by Becket enraged Henry II upon Becket's return to England?	☐	☐	☐	
57	What angry phrase is Henry II famously (though perhaps mythically) said to have shouted?	☐	☐	☐	
58	Where exactly was Thomas Becket murdered?	☐	☐	☐	
59	What happened to Canterbury after Becket's murder?	☐	☐	☐	
60	How did Henry II show penance for Becket's death?	☐	☐	☐	

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Date: _____

Lesson 4: Magna Carta (1215): A triumph of liberty or a selfish baronial power grab?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
61	Which king introduced common law and royal courts in 1154?	☐	☐	☐	
62	Who did Henry II appoint as Archbishop of Canterbury?	☐	☐	☐	
63	Why did Henry and Becket clash?	☐	☐	☐	
64	What happened to Thomas Becket in 1170?	☐	☐	☐	
65	What did the Pope do to Henry II as punishment?	☐	☐	☐	
66	Who won the Battle of Hastings?	☐	☐	☐	
67	What was the Domesday Book?	☐	☐	☐	
68	What is a 'criminous clerk'?	☐	☐	☐	
69	Why did Henry II walk barefoot through Canterbury being whipped?	☐	☐	☐	
70	What is a motte and bailey?	☐	☐	☐	
71	What territories did King John famously lose early in his reign?	☐	☐	☐	
72	What does the nickname 'Lackland' refer to?	☐	☐	☐	
73	How did King John try to fund his wars in France?	☐	☐	☐	
74	What did the Pope do to King John during their dispute?	☐	☐	☐	
75	Where did the barons confront King John to force him to seal Magna Carta?	☐	☐	☐	
76	What does 'Magna Carta' translate to in English?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
77	Which of the following was a key clause in Magna Carta?	☐	☐	☐	
78	Who was largely excluded from the protections of Magna Carta in 1215?	☐	☐	☐	
79	What did King John do almost immediately after sealing Magna Carta?	☐	☐	☐	
80	What war broke out as a direct result of King John breaking his promises in Magna Carta?	☐	☐	☐	

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Lesson 5: Doom Paintings and Tithes: What was life like in a medieval village?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
81	What percentage of the population in medieval England lived in rural farming communities?	☐	☐	☐	
82	What was a 'villein' in the feudal system?	☐	☐	☐	
83	Which of the following could a villein NOT do without their lord's permission?	☐	☐	☐	
84	What kind of houses did villeins typically live in?	☐	☐	☐	
85	Why did peasants often share their huts with animals in the winter?	☐	☐	☐	
86	What dictated the daily lives and labor of medieval peasants?	☐	☐	☐	
87	What was the most crucial task for a peasant in late summer?	☐	☐	☐	
88	What was the 'tithe'?	☐	☐	☐	
89	Who controlled the minds and spiritual lives of the peasants?	☐	☐	☐	
90	Why did almost no peasant refuse to pay the tithe, even during famines?	☐	☐	☐	
91	What was a Doom Painting?	☐	☐	☐	
92	Why did the Church rely on visual art like Doom Paintings?	☐	☐	☐	
93	According to Doom Paintings, what happened to obedient Christians?	☐	☐	☐	
94	How were sinners depicted in Doom Paintings?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
95	What was Purgatory in medieval Catholic belief?	☐	☐	☐	
96	How could a peasant theoretically shorten their time in Purgatory?	☐	☐	☐	
97	What building was the 'stone heart' of every medieval village?	☐	☐	☐	
98	When did peasants typically slaughter their animals?	☐	☐	☐	
99	What would happen if the late summer harvest failed?	☐	☐	☐	
100	What material was typically used to build a peasant's hut?	☐	☐	☐	

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Lesson 6: 1348: How did the Black Death shatter medieval social order?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
101	Which king lost Normandy and Aquitaine to the French?	☐	☐	☐	
102	What mocking nickname was given to King John?	☐	☐	☐	
103	Why were the barons angry with King John?	☐	☐	☐	
104	What document was King John forced to seal in 1215?	☐	☐	☐	
105	What was the most important principle of Magna Carta?	☐	☐	☐	
106	Where was Thomas Becket murdered?	☐	☐	☐	
107	What does 'excommunication' mean?	☐	☐	☐	
108	Who built the first motte and bailey castles in England?	☐	☐	☐	
109	What was the Harrying of the North?	☐	☐	☐	
110	What did Henry II want to stop Church courts from doing?	☐	☐	☐	
111	How did the Black Death originally reach England?	☐	☐	☐	
112	What is a 'bubo'?	☐	☐	☐	
113	Which of these was a strange cure medieval people attempted to use for the plague?	☐	☐	☐	
114	What is 'miasma'?	☐	☐	☐	
115	Who were the flagellants?	☐	☐	☐	
116	What economic situation did the massive death toll create in England?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
117	Because there were fewer workers after the Black Death, what did the surviving peasants do?	☐	☐	☐	
118	What was the Statute of Labourers (1351)?	☐	☐	☐	
119	How did the Black Death fundamentally weaken the feudal system?	☐	☐	☐	
120	Why did many peasants lose faith in the Catholic Church during the Black Death?	☐	☐	☐	

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Lesson 7: 1381: Why did the Peasants revolt, and did they achieve anything?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
121	In what year did the Black Death arrive in England?	☐	☐	☐	
122	What fraction of the English population was killed by the plague?	☐	☐	☐	
123	What were 'buboes'?	☐	☐	☐	
124	Why couldn't medieval doctors cure the plague?	☐	☐	☐	
125	What supernatural reason did people blame for the plague?	☐	☐	☐	
126	What document limited King John's power in 1215?	☐	☐	☐	
127	Who was murdered by four knights in 1170?	☐	☐	☐	
128	Why did King John charge heavy 'scutage' taxes?	☐	☐	☐	
129	What was the Domesday Book used for?	☐	☐	☐	
130	Who won the Battle of Stamford Bridge in 1066?	☐	☐	☐	
131	Why was the Poll Tax of 1380 seen as particularly unfair?	☐	☐	☐	
132	Who was John Ball?	☐	☐	☐	
133	What famous rhyme did John Ball use to question the feudal system?	☐	☐	☐	
134	What did the rebel army do when they entered London?	☐	☐	☐	
135	Which two high-ranking officials were dragged from the Tower of London and beheaded by the rebels?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
136	How old was King Richard II during the Peasants' Revolt in 1381?	☐	☐	☐	
137	Where did King Richard II ride out to meet Wat Tyler?	☐	☐	☐	
138	What was one of the radical demands Wat Tyler made to the King?	☐	☐	☐	
139	Who stabbed Wat Tyler during the meeting with the King?	☐	☐	☐	
140	What did King Richard II do immediately after Wat Tyler was killed?	☐	☐	☐	

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Lesson 8: The Wars of the Roses (1455–1485) - How did the medieval era end in blood?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
141	What was the name of the brutal 30-year civil war that began in 1455?	☐	☐	☐	
142	Which two rival branches of the royal family fought in the Wars of the Roses?	☐	☐	☐	
143	What flower symbolized the House of Lancaster?	☐	☐	☐	
144	What flower symbolized the House of York?	☐	☐	☐	
145	Why did the Wars of the Roses initially break out?	☐	☐	☐	
146	What territory had King Henry VI lost before the Wars of the Roses began?	☐	☐	☐	
147	Who died in 1483, leaving a 12-year-old son to inherit the throne?	☐	☐	☐	
148	Who was the ambitious uncle of the 12-year-old King Edward V?	☐	☐	☐	
149	Where did Richard of Gloucester place his two nephews, supposedly for their own protection?	☐	☐	☐	
150	What happened to the two young princes after they were placed in the Tower?	☐	☐	☐	
151	What did Richard III do after declaring his nephews illegitimate?	☐	☐	☐	
152	How did the disappearance of the Princes in the Tower affect Richard III?	☐	☐	☐	
153	What was the final, decisive battle of the Wars of the Roses?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
154	In what year did the Battle of Bosworth take place?	☐	☐	☐	
155	Who invaded England to challenge Richard III for the throne at Bosworth?	☐	☐	☐	
156	What crucial event happened during the Battle of Bosworth that doomed Richard III?	☐	☐	☐	
157	What unique distinction does Richard III hold among English monarchs?	☐	☐	☐	
158	Who was crowned King of England after Richard III's death?	☐	☐	☐	
159	How did Henry VII attempt to heal the division between the rival houses?	☐	☐	☐	
160	What historical period is generally considered to have ended with the Battle of Bosworth?	☐	☐	☐	

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THE VAULT

Restricted Access: Answer Keys

Lesson 1: 1066 - Why did three men claim one throne, and how did William win?

1. The 11th century (1000s).
2. The Anglo-Saxons.
3. The church.
4. The person legally next in line to become king or queen.
5. Edward the Confessor.
6. The council of powerful English lords and bishops.
7. The Vikings.
8. In northern France.
9. To assert that you have the right to be the next monarch.
10. A situation where a government has no identifiable central authority or leader.
11. Harold Godwinson
12. Harald Hardrada
13. That William would be the next king
14. They had just marched rapidly from a battle in the north
15. A shield wall
16. By faking a retreat to lure them down the hill
17. He was shot in the eye by an arrow
18. The Bayeux Tapestry
19. The death of Edward the Confessor without a clear heir
20. They had archers and cavalry on horseback

Lesson 2: Castles, Terror, and the Domesday Book - How did William control England?

21. Harold Godwinson.
22. Harald Hardrada.
23. William, Duke of Normandy.
24. Stamford Bridge (in the north).
25. King Harold Godwinson.
26. They had just marched 300 miles south after fighting a brutal battle.
27. Pevensey, on the south coast.

28. The Pope.
29. The Battle of Hastings.
30. 1066.
31. A large mound of earth with a wooden tower on top
32. The enclosed courtyard where soldiers lived
33. They were quick to build and visually intimidating
34. 1069
35. Mass starvation and widespread deaths among the northern population
36. French
37. Everything that everyone owned across England
38. Because its decisions were as final as the Day of Judgement (Doomsday)
39. Military service
40. That he retained ultimate ownership and control over all land in England

Lesson 3: Crown vs Church: Why did Henry II clash with Thomas Becket?

41. William the Conqueror.
42. Motte and bailey castles.
43. A large, hand-dug mound of earth.
44. The Harrying of the North.
45. To survey the wealth of the country for taxation.
46. Harald Hardrada.
47. Wood.
48. The fenced compound where soldiers lived and horses were stabled.
49. A system where land is given in exchange for military service or labour.
50. Over 100,000.
51. They gave much lighter punishments to priests who committed crimes
52. They were close friends and drinking companions
53. A scratchy hair shirt to show religious devotion
54. The Constitutions of Clarendon
55. Six years
56. He excommunicated the bishops who had supported the King
57. 'Will no one rid me of this turbulent priest?'
58. Inside Canterbury Cathedral near the altar
59. It became one of the most important pilgrimage sites in Europe
60. He walked barefoot to the cathedral and allowed monks to whip him

Lesson 4: Magna Carta (1215): A triumph of liberty or a selfish baronial power grab?

61. King Henry II.
62. Thomas Becket.
63. Over the power of Church courts and 'criminous clerks'.
64. He was murdered by four of the King's knights in Canterbury Cathedral.
65. He threatened him with excommunication, forcing Henry to do penance.
66. William the Conqueror.
67. A massive survey used to maximize taxation in 1086.
68. A member of the clergy accused of a serious crime like murder.
69. As public penance for his role in Becket's murder.
70. An early wooden castle built by the Normans.
71. Most of England's lands in France, including Normandy
72. John's failure to inherit significant lands compared to his older brothers

- 73. By imposing massive, arbitrary taxes on the barons
- 74. He excommunicated John and banned church services in England
- 75. Runnymede
- 76. The Great Charter
- 77. No free man shall be imprisoned without a fair trial
- 78. The unfree peasants (villeins) who made up the majority of the population
- 79. He complained to the Pope and had the document declared void
- 80. The First Barons' War

Lesson 5: Doom Paintings and Tithes: What was life like in a medieval village?

81. Over 90%
82. An unfree peasant tied to the land
83. Leave the village or marry
84. Single-room wattle-and-daub huts
85. To keep warm
86. The seasons
87. Harvesting crops
88. A tax requiring 1/10th of a peasant's produce to go to the Church
89. The Catholic Church
90. They feared eternal damnation in Hell
91. A giant mural painted in churches depicting the Day of Judgement
92. Because the vast majority of peasants were illiterate
93. They were welcomed into Heaven by angels
94. Naked and being dragged by demons into Hell
95. A place of suffering before Heaven
96. By obeying the priest and paying tithes
97. The parish church
98. In the autumn
99. The village would face starvation
100. Wattle-and-daub

Lesson 6: 1348: How did the Black Death shatter medieval social order?

101. King John.
102. Softsword.
103. He imposed heavy taxes (scutage) and lost wars.
104. Magna Carta.
105. That no one, not even the King, is above the law.
106. Canterbury Cathedral.
107. Being officially thrown out of the Catholic Church.
108. William the Conqueror.
109. William's brutal destruction of crops to stop northern rebellions.
110. Giving lenient punishments to criminal clerks.
111. On trading ships arriving at southern ports like Melcombe Regis
112. A painfully swollen lymph node, usually in the armpit or groin
113. Strapping a live toad or chicken to the buboes

- 114. The medieval belief that bad smells and corrupt air caused disease
- 115. Religious zealots who whipped themselves to earn God's forgiveness and stop the plague
- 116. A severe labour shortage
- 117. They demanded higher wages and better working conditions
- 118. A law passed by the government to freeze peasant wages at pre-plague levels
- 119. Lords had to start paying villeins or risk them running away to rival lords
- 120. Because priests were dying just like everyone else, and their prayers hadn't stopped the disease

Lesson 7: 1381: Why did the Peasants revolt, and did they achieve anything?

- 121. 1348.
- 122. Roughly one third.
- 123. Agonizing, pus-filled swellings caused by the bubonic plague.
- 124. Because germ theory did not exist yet.
- 125. They believed it was a divine punishment sent by God.
- 126. Magna Carta.
- 127. Thomas Becket.
- 128. To fund his failed wars to recapture Normandy.
- 129. To record wealth and property for taxation.
- 130. Harold Godwinson.
- 131. It charged every person the exact same amount, meaning it hit the poor much harder than the rich
- 132. A radical priest who preached that all men were created equal by God
- 133. 'When Adam delved and Eve span, who was then the gentleman?'
- 134. They burned down the Savoy Palace and opened the prisons
- 135. The Archbishop of Canterbury and the Lord Treasurer
- 136. 14 years old
- 137. Smithfield
- 138. The total abolition of serfdom and the feudal system
- 139. The Mayor of London
- 140. He rode toward the angry mob and convinced them he would be their leader

Lesson 8: The Wars of the Roses (1455–1485) - How did the medieval era end in blood?

- 141. The Wars of the Roses
- 142. The House of Lancaster and the House of York
- 143. A red rose
- 144. A white rose
- 145. King Henry VI was a weak, mentally unstable ruler
- 146. England's lands in France
- 147. The Yorkist King Edward IV
- 148. Richard of Gloucester (later Richard III)
- 149. The Tower of London
- 150. They were never seen in public again
- 151. He crowned himself King of England
- 152. It shocked the country and turned many nobles against him

153.The Battle of Bosworth Field

154.1485

155.Henry Tudor

156.Several of his key allies betrayed him and refused to fight

157. He was the last English king to die in battle

158.Henry VII

159.He married a princess from the House of York

160.The Middle Ages

Mastery Tracker

Track your total recall score across all 160 questions.

Attempt	Date	Score (/160)	Parent/Guardian Signature	Target for Next Time
1				
2				
3				

Operative Reflection

My ultimate strength in this unit is...

The three specific facts I need to hunt down and memorize tonight are...